

THE LOCKED ROOM

A digital escape room for **any subject and any grade**. Open the file, put your own clues in, and run it the same day. Your class picks which lock to attack — the simple one, the sturdy one, or the stiff one that pays off — and a wrong answer jams the lock instead of ending anything, so it waits right there until somebody comes back and clears it.

10

minutes from opening this to
running your own version

1

file, no installing, no accounts,
works offline

0

timers, fail states, or ways to
lose in front of the class

Your clues go in without touching any code.

There is a setup screen built into the game. Type them in, or use the prompt on page 5 to have AI draft a whole room in about thirty seconds and then read them over. Press **Save my game as a file** and you have your own copy to keep, reuse and hand to the teacher next door.

Why the jam is the whole design

A wrong answer does not end anything. It jams that lock, in plain sight, and the room stays exactly as open as it was. Going back for it and clearing it is the loudest moment in the game — louder than any lock that opens on the first try — because feeling capable is what actually drives students to keep going, and a jam fixed is proof of that.

What is in this pack

The finished room · ten minutes to make it yours · how to write a clue worth answering · how the room works and how to run it · three copy-and-paste prompts that change the game itself · the fixes for what actually goes wrong · and where your things live.

Ten minutes, start to finish

Do these in order. Your class is picking locks in your own room by the end of step four.

1 Unzip the folder and double-click `locked-room.html`

It opens in whatever browser you already use. Nothing installs, nothing asks you to sign in. The sample room is about the water cycle, so open a lock or two to see the shape of it before you change anything.

2 Press Put my own clues in

It is on the opening screen, under the Start button. That is the setup screen, and it is the only place you ever need to go.

3 Fill in the room name, what is behind the final door, and what you are reviewing

The final-door line is one sentence of flavor — "the supply closet," "the roof," "Friday." It takes nine seconds and the whole room reads as though it was written for your class, because it was.

4 Get your clues in, by whichever of these suits you

Have AI draft them. Copy the prompt the screen gives you, paste it into whichever AI tool you use, paste the answer back into the box, press Load. About thirty seconds. **Read them before you play them** — AI gets things wrong, and you are the one who knows your standards. **Or type them in** on the same screen, one card per clue.

5 Press Save my game as a file

This is the step people skip and regret. It hands you back a single file with your clues already inside it. Put it wherever you keep your own work. It opens on any computer, it survives clearing your browsing data, and you can email it to a colleague who can then change it for their own class.

Keep the original. Save each room as its own file — `fractions.html`, `cell-parts.html`, `chapter-7.html` — and leave `locked-room.html` as it came. Then a room you want back next year is still there, and you always have a clean copy to start from.

A clue worth answering

The room is the same whatever you put in it. **The clues are the lesson**, and four small decisions on the setup screen are what separate a room students beg to try again from a quiz with a padlock drawn on it.

On the screen	What it is for	Getting it right
The question	What you are asking	One idea per clue. If a student needs two things to answer it, a jam does not tell you which one they are missing.
Idea it tests	The game never shows two locks on the same idea side by side, so the choice at every turn is a real one	Three or four ideas across the room, several locks each. This is the setting most people get wrong. Ten different ideas gives the room nothing to work with.
Level	Students choose their own difficulty by choosing the lock, so every level needs clues waiting	Roughly a third each. Level 1 is recall, level 2 is applying it, level 3 is reasoning about something they have not seen before.
Why the answer is right	The one line held on screen after a jam	Write this one properly. It is the only teaching the room does. A student who just jammed a lock should be able to learn from this sentence alone, with nobody explaining it.

What a good "why" line sounds like

Weak: "Evaporation is the correct answer." That tells a student who just jammed the lock absolutely nothing.

Strong: "The water did not go anywhere solid or liquid. Heat turned it into vapor." Now the jam was worth something.

Eight to fourteen clues across three or four ideas is a room

Fewer than eight and the room opens in under a minute. More than about fourteen and a single room stops being a quick review and starts being a test, which is not what anybody is here for. Make as many rooms as you like; each is its own saved file.

A distractor has to be wrong. Make the three wrong answers plausible, but never defensible — in a paper quiz a disputed answer costs one point, in a room it can stop the whole class arguing instead of finishing. The setup screen's AI prompt tells the AI this directly; read the four answers it gives you before you trust any of them.

HOW IT PLAYS

The room, the jam, and no way to lose

Four or five locks are in reach at once. Whichever one a student picks **is the decision** — it comes before the question, not after it.

Pick a lock, any lock

A simple lock asks a level-1 clue. A stiff one asks a level-3 clue and is worth more of the room. Two classes with the same clues will clear a room in a different order, because which lock looked worth the risk is a real choice every time.

Wrong jams it. Right opens it. Nothing else happens.

A jammed lock stays on screen, visibly stuck, and it is always still clickable — there is no cooldown and no penalty beyond having to come back to it. There is no timer counting down and no way for the room to end badly. Every room opens, eventually.

Clearing a jam is the loudest moment in the game

The only full-screen celebration in the room belongs to a lock that was wrong and is now right. Opening a fresh lock earns a quiet acknowledgment; clearing a jam stops the room for a second to say so.

Three ways to run it

Whole class, projected. The room comes up, the class argues about which lock to try, you click. **Pairs on one device**, with a rule that they agree before clicking — that rule is the whole activity. **A station in the corner** with no login and no way to lose, so a student arriving mid-period can simply pick up where the last one left it.

Nobody is ranked and nobody is out. There is nowhere to type a student's name and no per-student score. The tally on screen is locks opened and ideas cracked for the whole room, and it only ever goes up.

Three prompts that change the game itself

Everything so far needed no code. This page is the other half: **the game is one file you own, so you can change how it works**, not just what it asks. Open `locked-room.html` in any AI assistant that accepts a file, paste one of these, and ask for the whole file back. Save the result as a **new** file and keep the old one.

1 · CHANGE THE ROOM

Change the setting from a storeroom to a ship's cabin. Keep every rule exactly as it is — the locks, the jamming, the celebration. Change only the words, the colors and the shapes drawn. Give me the whole file back.

2 · CHANGE THE ROOM'S SIZE

Make a room have six locks instead of the current number, and tell me which line I change to do that myself next time.

3 · READ IT FROM THE BACK

Increase every font size by about a quarter and raise the contrast on the lock buttons, keeping the layout intact at 1280 by 720 on a projector. Give me the whole file back.

Three rules that will save you an afternoon. Change **one** thing per prompt, and play it before you ask for the next one. Always say *give me the whole file back*, or you will get a fragment and no way to place it. And always save under a new name — then a result you dislike costs you nothing at all.

The things that actually break

In order of how often they happen.

What you see	What to do
"Not ready to play yet", with a list	Nothing is broken. The room will not start on clues it cannot use, and the list names every one. The usual causes are an empty fourth answer and a missing why line.
Pasted clues did not load	Every line needs eight parts separated by the character. If the AI numbered the lines or added a sentence of its own, delete those lines and press Load again. The message tells you which line numbers it skipped and why.
The room opens in under a minute	You have fewer than eight clues. The setup screen warns you; add more before you run it for the class.
The same idea keeps showing up next to itself	Most of your clues are tagged with one idea. Give the room three or four, several clues each.
A lock only ever asks easy questions	There are no level-2 or level-3 clues left. Add a few harder ones so choosing a lock is a real decision.
A class argues that a "wrong" answer was actually right	Read that clue's four answers again. AI sometimes writes a distractor that is technically defensible — fix the wording or swap it before you run the room again.
Your clues disappeared	They were kept in the browser and the browsing data was cleared, or you opened the file on a different computer. This is exactly what Save my game as a file prevents, and why page 2 puts it in step five.
It will not open at all	Right-click the file, choose Open with, and pick a browser. A school laptop sometimes tries to open an HTML file in a text editor.
An AI change broke the game	Delete that file and open the copy you kept. This is the whole reason page 5 says to save under a new name.

Before you project it

A room is darker than a daylight scene by design. Open it on the classroom projector once before class and check the lock buttons read clearly from the back row.

What it does not do, and where your things live

Breakout EDU exists, and it is good

Their School Digital+ subscription starts at \$1,499 a year, and it buys a library of premade rooms plus a management platform. A one-time \$14 file is a different trade, and it is worth being plain about it: **no subscription, no login for anybody, works with the wifi down, cannot be blocked or switched off, and every rule in it is yours to change.** Most classroom escape rooms sold on TPT are a Google Form or a slide deck with a code typed into a box, usually \$3–8; ours is real software with real locks that a teacher can reshape by asking. Pick whichever suits the day — a library of finished rooms is genuinely useful, and so is one you own outright.

Where your things live, in three lines

Your clues. On this page while you type them, and in your own file once you press Save. They are yours, they are not about any student, and they are transmitted nowhere.

The class best. Ideas cracked and misses only, kept in that one browser on that one computer. No names, because there is nowhere to put one.

Anything you paste into an AI tool. That leaves the room, and it goes to a company. Clues about the water cycle are fine. **A student's name, work, score, or anything about their needs is not** — that is the line, it does not move, and it applies to every AI tool your building uses.

The most-asked feature, refused on purpose. There is no leaderboard with student names, and there will not be one. It would put children's names and performance into a file that gets emailed around, and ranking students publicly does the most damage to the ones already struggling. The tally the game keeps is **ideas cracked**, it only ever goes up, and the biggest moment in the whole room belongs to the student who jammed a lock and then cleared it.

What this pack is not

It is not a course in programming, and it does not teach you to build a room from nothing. It hands you a working one, shows you how to fill it with your own clues in ten minutes, and shows you how to change it by asking. That is the whole promise, and it is the whole of what is in the box.

License, credit, and one favor

What you may do

Use it with your own students for as long as you teach. Change it however you like. Save as many rooms as you want. Put it on the classroom computers, on a flash drive, on a laptop cart. Your one purchase covers you and your classes.

What needs another license

Sharing it with other teachers, putting it on a shared drive or server, or handing it round a department or a building. Additional licenses are half price on the listing, and a school can buy them on a single purchase order. Please do not post the file publicly or sell anything made from it.

A note on the shape of the game

Locked rooms, padlocks and a wrong answer that jams the way forward are old ideas that belong to nobody, and you are welcome to build on them. The words, the art and the code in this file are ours. That distinction is worth knowing if you start changing games with AI: **how a game works is free to borrow, and the way a particular game says and draws it is not.** Build on the idea, write your own words.

If this earned its keep, would you leave a review? TPT gives you credits toward your next purchase for it, and it is the only thing that decides whether another teacher ever sees this. If something did not work, tell us that instead and we will fix it.

Built and audited by two certified teachers

Written by classroom teachers, used with real classes, and checked by a second teacher before it shipped. The room was played start to finish, on a teacher's own set of clues, before this pack was published.